

Resources for Engineering Managers and Software Engineers

A checklist for engineering managers, business case for a platform team, project lead expectations, performance reviews and others



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AUG 30, 2021 • PAID



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Share



Below are documents and templates that hundreds of engineering managers and engineers have used with success at various companies. I'll add new ones to this page, as I come around to the several other templates that served me over the years.

Resources shared include:

[For engineering managers:](#)

- Measuring the impact of an engineering team
- Preparing for a reorg as an EM
- Checklist for (New) Engineering Managers: the checklist I wish I had
- Tech Lead Expectations to empower engineers to lead projects
- Narrative/Business Case for a Platform team used to create one
- Performance Review Example and Template for EMs
- Promotions Map for EMs to visualize promotions progress
- Oncall compensation data
- Checklist for growing a (junior-heavy) team
- Checklist for planning preparation for engineering managers
- Project reporting example for regular engineering project updates.
- Preparing for layoffs: a checklist

- Uber's Engineering Metrics Dashboard
- Staying technical as an engineering manager: resources
- Pragmatic Engineer Talent Collective and Job Board special offers for subscribers: posting jobs for free, or with a discount

Hiring:

- Software engineering interview process
- EM interview process
- Interview processes at Sourcegraph

Onboarding:

- Onboarding Overview
- Onboarding Task List
- Onboarding Email Example
- Onboarding Checklist for Engineering Managers
- Onboarding Check-In Questionnaire that many places use to check-in around the one-month timeframe

Performance reviews:

- Preparing for promotions: a checklist.
- Work Log
- Self-review for performance reviews.
- Numbers in self-reviews for software engineers.

Career-related:

- Resources to find great tech jobs: 100+ of the highest paying jobs, and 50+ places to find promising high-growth startups and a list of the best executive recruitment firms in tech

- Writing goals and accountability document: to help making progress in becoming a better writer.
- "Wartime" vs "peacetime" differences

For software engineers:

- What is a senior engineer at Big Tech?
- A migration checklist
- Incident Analysis Templates
- Project reporting example
- Performance Review Example
- Work Log Template for software engineers
- Team Standup Template

Reports:

- Shopify's engineering levels in 2023
- AI coding tools: research data and GitHub Copilot alternatives
- Curbing vendor costs in 2023: details
- Tech compensation changes in 2023
- Microsoft's 2022 compensation numbers
- Pay transparency data at Pollen, in 2022 (UK, US, Poland)

I do not suggest blindly copying any of these documents. Instead, use them as inspiration. They worked for me for my specific situations over the years. Your situation - business context, team structure, team dynamics - will be different, and you'll want to tailor for this context. If you think they'll help: give it a go, iterate on them, and make them yours!

Consider creating your own "templates" for common situations you come across: and share them with your peers for feedback. This is how I created many of these

documents: and I have always been surprised by the quality and quantity of helpful feedback received.

What are other documents, templates, or approaches that you'd find helpful? Please send a message or leave a comment.

For Engineering Managers

-  [Measuring the impact of an engineering team](#)
-  [Preparing for a reorg as an EM](#): a summary, based on [this article about reorgs](#).
-  [Checklist for \(New\) Engineering Managers](#): the checklist that I wish I had when starting out as a new engineering manager. Read more [about how this list was born here](#).
-  [Checklist for Growing a \(Junior-Heavy\) Engineering Team](#): actions you can take to help junior members on the team level up faster.
-  [Checklist for Planning](#): a list of activities that can help reach more aligned planning outcomes: ones that benefit the team and the company more.
-  [Oncall compensation data](#). How much do companies pay for oncall?
-  [Tech Lead Expectations Document](#) to empower engineers to lead project leads. Includes a more prescriptive checklist for first-time project leads. For more context, please see the article [An engineering team where everyone is a leader](#).
-  [Narrative/Business Case for a Platform team](#). This is an anonymized document of a business case used to found a Product Platform team in a niche domain.
-  [Performance Review Example and Template for EMs](#) as a supporting document for the article [Performance reviews for software engineers](#).
-  [Promotions Map](#) to visualize career progress, and promotions on a team.
-  [Project reporting example](#) to communicate the progress of engineering projects.

-  [Preparing for layoffs: a checklist](#). If there is no other choice, support for executing this as humanly as possible.
-  [Resources to find great tech jobs](#) including a list of the best-known executive recruitment firms.
-  [Writing goals and accountability document](#) to be deliberate in improving your writing.
-  [Uber's Engineering Metrics Dashboard](#). How the company measures engineering productivity, and the metrics it exposes to all software engineers.
-  [Staying technical as an engineering manager: resources](#). Newsletters, podcasts and educational resources.

Hiring

Hiring software engineers

-  [Software engineer interview process](#): an overview.
-  [Scorecard template](#) for the Coding interview.
-  [Debrief summary](#): an example of a document prepared before the debrief.
-  [Hiring loops at Sourcegraph](#)

Hiring engineering managers

-  [EM interview process documented](#)
-  [A specific EM interview documented](#): the Leadership & Alignment interview.

Onboarding

-  [Onboarding Overview](#) describing the onboarding process
-  [Onboarding Task List](#) defining tasks various people participating in onboarding need to complete
-  [Onboarding Email Example](#) that can be sent out after the offer is accepted

-  [Onboarding Checklist for Engineering Managers](#) that also serves as a collection of manager-only resources within the company
-  [Onboarding Check-In Questionnaire](#) that many places use to check-in around the one-month timeframe

Performance reviews

-  [Preparing for promotions: a checklist](#). A checklist created based on the article.
-  [Work Log](#) to record activities that you did. Helpful for performance reviews or promotions, later on.
-  [Self-review for performance reviews](#). An example.
-  [Numbers in self-reviews for software engineers](#). Inspiration for ones you can use.

Career-related

-  [Resources to find great tech jobs](#), including a list of the best-known executive recruitment firms.
-  [Writing goals and accountability document](#) to be deliberate in improving your writing.
-  ["Wartime" vs "peacetime" differences](#)

For Software Engineers

-  [What is a senior engineer at Big Tech?](#)
-  [A migration checklist](#) to plan and validate migrations.
-  **Incident Analysis Templates:** [Heavyweight](#) and [Lightweight](#) templates.
-  [Project reporting example](#) to communicate the progress of engineering projects.

-  [Performance Review Example and Template for Software Engineers](#) to serve as inspiration for a format and content.
-  [Team Standup Template](#) for remote/async standups - a format similar to what my team used at Uber.

Reports

- [Shopify's engineering levels in 2023](#)
- AI coding tools: [research data](#) and a list of [GitHub Copilot and ChatGPT alternatives](#)
- [Curbing vendor costs in 2023: details](#)
- [Tech compensation changes in 2023](#)
- [Microsoft's 2022 compensation numbers](#)
- Pay transparency data at Pollen, in 2022 (UK, US, Poland)
 - [The report](#)
 - [Tech compensation numbers](#)
 - [Regional pay differences](#)

The Pragmatic Engineer Talent Collective Job Board

The [Pragmatic Engineer Talent Collective](#) is one of the best places to hire software engineers, data engineers, and engineering managers. Read the [job board testimonials](#). Newsletter subscribers have access to the following discounts:

- **25% off the featured package for the first 3 months.** Choose the package "Featured" and use the code *FEATURED*.
- **30% off the bulk package for the first 6 months.** Choose the package "Featured" and use the code *BULK*.
- **Positions listing salary ranges** see about 5x as many applications.

Job ads are shown to free newsletter subscribers, and on The Pragmatic Engineer blog.



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22 Comments



Write a comment...



Sandrina Pereira Aug 27, 2022 ❤️ Liked by Gergely Orosz

Hi Gergely! I noticed the "Oncall compensation data" link is broken. Could you fix it? :)

♡ LIKE (3) 💬 REPLY ...

3 replies by Gergely Orosz and others



Pruthvi Aug 15, 2022 ❤️ Liked by Gergely Orosz

Hi Gergely, the link of "Tech Lead Expectations Document " refers to <https://docs.google.com/document/d/1EqWp4CMeGY6AljmMURNcs9a4o7-NMF2lbMsMiesxuHw/edit> and this doc mentions that resource has been moved. Can you please help with link of the new resource?

Thanks!

♡ LIKE (1) 💬 REPLY ...

1 reply by Gergely Orosz

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